# Perioperative Theatre Safety Precautions

*Study notes — general theatre safety domains covered in most perioperative curricula.*

## Fire safety

- Fire triangle in theatre: oxygen-enriched atmosphere, ignition source (diathermy/laser), fuel (drapes, prep solution)
- Allow alcohol-based skin prep to fully dry before draping or using diathermy
- Know the location of fire extinguishers and the theatre evacuation route

## Electrical safety

- Inspect cables and plugs for damage before use
- Diathermy return electrode placed on clean, dry, well-vascularised muscle
- Report equipment faults immediately — do not attempt in-theatre repairs

## Radiation safety (image-guided procedures)

- Time, distance, shielding — the three basic principles
- Lead aprons and thyroid shields worn when C-arm/fluoroscopy is in use
- Pregnant staff to notify their supervisor and follow local policy

## General theatre discipline

- Restricted, semi-restricted, and unrestricted zones respected
- Theatre attire (scrubs, cap, mask) worn correctly in each zone
- Traffic through theatre kept to a minimum during a procedure

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